Project Futures

Partnership with Business Project
2022-2023

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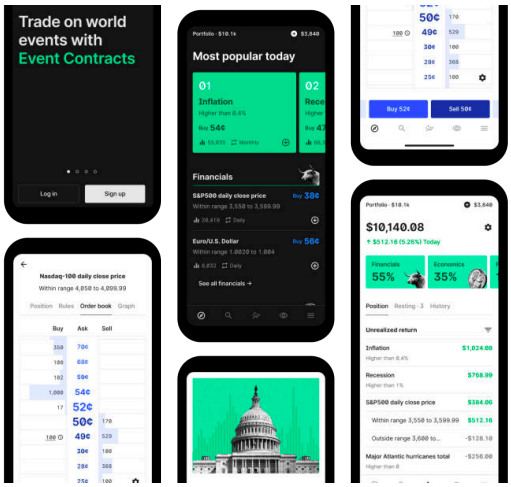
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Purpose

The world of trading offers a range of different options, including stocks, bonds, commodities, and more. Each of these options comes with its own unique set of risks and challenges, and navigating the complexities of the financial markets can be a difficult and daunting task. All of these trading options require significant knowledge, research, and experience, and even the most seasoned investors can struggle to achieve consistent success in the markets.

Enter Kalshi, a financial technology company that offers a new type of trading platform designed to bring transparency and fairness to the financial markets. With Kalshi, users can trade on a range of event contracts that allow them to speculate on the outcome of various real-world events. Users are able to find success in investing by using their knowledge and street smarts to make trades on a level playing field. In addition, Kalshi acts as a powerful forecaster. By utilizing Kalshi's predictive markets, users can access a wealth of information that can help them make informed decisions on their other investments. Monta Vista FBLA strongly resonated with Kalshi's mission and thus began a mutually beneficial partnership, which allowed Kalshi to grow its impact in the Bay Area and also exposed MVFBLA members to the workings of a successful fintech startup.



Goals

Quantifiable Goals to Benefit Members

Project Futures established five goals to benefit and educate its members. These goals were tailored to support members by providing opportunities for students to develop career-oriented business skills, like design, data-analysis, and marketing, as well as soft skills such as collaboration and presentational skills.

Goal	Strategies for Implementation
Impact a minimum of 60 members through interactive and educational events.	‣ Organize weekly project meetings to help members develop their business knowledge and skills. ‣ Conduct a minimum of three workshops for members to acquire more in-depth knowledge about specific business concepts. ‣ Schedule at least three collaborative work events for members to participate in. ‣ Invite business professionals to host guest speaker workshops for members to learn about various fields and broaden their knowledge.
Improve members' graphic design skills and their application of design thinking in Kalshi feature development.	‣ Conduct at least two workshops to introduce members to key design concepts, such as design thinking and user-centered design principles, to enhance their design skills. ‣ Provide members with at least one opportunity to apply their design skills. ‣ Help members understand the practical applications of design thinking in solving problems within and outside of business contexts.

Goal	Strategies for Implementation
Enhance the presentation, communication, and collaboration skills of members to equip them for success in their careers.	‣ Offer members at least two opportunities to present formal presentations to large audiences. ‣ Offer members at least three opportunities to collaborate with other members to develop a high-quality end product. ‣ Support members with developing and presenting compelling pitches to advocate for their ideas.
Build members' skills in collecting and analyzing data, and their understanding of its importance in business.	‣ Teach members about data collection and analysis of a business's competitors and users and their respective importance ‣ Introduce diverse methods of collecting and analyzing data using a variety of charts, diagrams, and analytical techniques. ‣ Provide members with opportunities to apply their learning.
Educate members on marketing principles and the implementation of diverse marketing skills and tactics.	‣ Organize an interactive workshop to educated members about fundamental marketing concepts. ‣ Apply these core concepts in the initiation of Kalshi's marketing campaigns through the creation of social media content.
Future goal: continue the above goals past the 2023 school year	‣ Continue hosting workshops to educate members across business topics ‣ Continue providing opportunities for members to apply their skills and present their ideas through competitions and more

Quantifiable Goals to Benefit Kalshi

Project Futures established five goals to benefit Kalshi through user research, feature creation and development, and marketing. These goals were created to maximize the contributions that Monta Vista FBLA members could offer, as well as the resources available in the technology-focused Silicon Valley.

Goal	Strategies for Implementation
Provide Kalshi with usable and relevant feedback for their app from at least 60 teenagers and young adults.	‣ Collect feedback data focus groups and written responses, Kalshi's preferred form of feedback. ‣ Conduct app feedback sessions with at least 15 Monta Vista FBLA members and 50 Bay Area adults. ‣ Familiarize the Bay Area community with Kalshi's app and service.
Create and edit features of Kalshi's app to expand its functionality.	‣ Research Kalshi users' needs and preferences. ‣ Generate at least 10 feasible changes to make to the Kalshi app to enhance user experience and address user feedback. ‣ Design widget features with graphics and benefits for Kalshi's implementation.
Assist in the success of the launch of Kalshi's new mobile app, Kalshi.	‣ Help Kalshi gain more than 100 app downloads to assist the initiation of their newly released app. ‣ Publicize Kalshi's app in the Bay Area community.

Goals/Business Leader Involvement 3

Goal	Strategies for Implementation
Expose Kalshi's target market to the company through unique integrated marketing campaigns.	‣ Brainstorm and detail methods which would most effectively publicize Kalshi. ‣ Utilize social media marketing and create content for Kalshi's social media pages. ‣ Use in-person methods, like a pop-up stand, to market Kalshi to the Bay Area community
Assist Kalshi with any immediate tasks which supports the development of their business.	‣ Hold weekly meetings with Kalshi professionals to plan and collaborate on strategies for business development. ‣ Utilize the communities present in Cupertino and the greater San Francisco Bay Area in any manner that may benefit Kalshi.
Future goal: continue the above goals past the 2023 year	‣ Continue providing user feedback to Kalshi through focus groups and surveys and assist with feature development ‣ Continue creating social media content to market Kalshi

Business Leader Involvement

Kalshi

Kalshi assigned a team of employees to be available for Monta Vista FBLA throughout the project's development. To ensure that the project was successful and impactful, the project leader maintained regular communication with the designated leaders.



Lior Hirschfield
Software Engineer

- Primary liaison between MVFBLA
- Provided feedback and support to students



Prabhath Kotha
Software Engineer

- Involved with initial planning of the partnership
- Guest speaker for workshops



David Xu
Product Engineering Intern

- Provided support in the organization of Project Futures' events
- Guest speaker for workshops

Monta Vista FBLA

As of late spring in the 2021-2022 school year, Evelyn Xie was appointed the Director of the Partnership with Business Project. The rest of the PWB committee was composed of Jaden Bae, Charmaine Chua, Spandan Dutta, Reema Karvir, Manas Kottakota, Swetha Vimalkumar, and Samuel Yao who supported Evelyn in the preparation and execution of events in Project Futures.

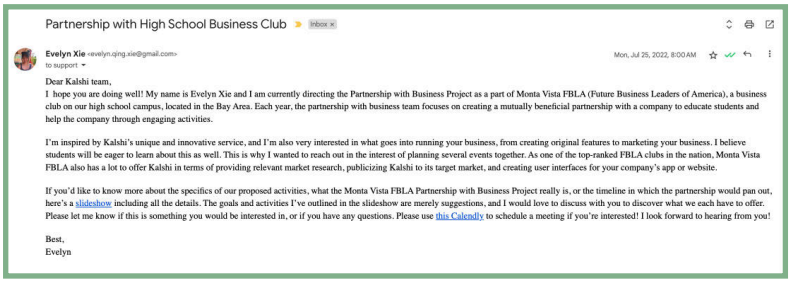
Project Lead
▸ Organize and plan workshops and promotional events ▸ Maintain constant communication with Lior, Prabhath, David, and other Kalshi employees ▸ Aid Kalshi in reaching potential Bay Area customers ▸ Communicate with other school clubs to help increase increase education and Kalshi publicity ▸ Contact city members and local organizations to receive recognition for chapter efforts
Committee Members
▸ Facilitate student-focused workshops and events ▸ Direct focus groups to provide feedback of user experience on Kalshi ▸ Facilitate the creation of social media campaigns ▸ Create infographics and designs and use social media, email marketing, and school programs to effectively promote workshops and the project

Planning

Partner Selection



In the summer of 2022, the project director Evelyn Xie reached out to over 20 potential partners via email and online meetings to establish a partnership. She sought to collaborate with a company that would be relevant and interesting to students, and it was essential that the business had a communicative and dedicated representative who was willing to work with the project director to ensure a successful partnership. She also preferred that the company was large enough to be attractive to students, but small enough for MVFBLA to make a meaningful and quantifiable impact. Ultimately, the project director narrowed it down to three potential partners.



Partnership with High School Business Club Inbox ×

Evelyn Xie <evelyn.qing.xie@gmail.com> Mon, Jul 25, 2022, 8:00 AM

to support

Dear Kalshi team,

I hope you are doing well! My name is Evelyn Xie and I am currently directing the Partnership with Business Project as a part of Monta Vista FBLA (Future Business Leaders of America), a business club on our high school campus, located in the Bay Area. Each year, the partnership with business team focuses on creating a mutually beneficial partnership with a company to educate students and help the company through engaging activities.

I'm inspired by Kalshi's unique and innovative service, and I'm also very interested in what goes into running your business, from creating original features to marketing your business. I believe students will be eager to learn about this as well. This is why I wanted to reach out in the interest of planning several events together. As one of the top-ranked FBLA clubs in the nation, Monta Vista FBLA also has a lot to offer Kalshi in terms of providing relevant market research, publicizing Kalshi to its target market, and creating user interfaces for your company's app or website.

If you'd like to know more about the specifics of our proposed activities, what the Monta Vista FBLA Partnership with Business Project really is, or the timeline in which the partnership would pan out, here's a slideshow including all the details. The goals and activities I've outlined in the slideshow are merely suggestions, and I would love to discuss with you to discover what we each have to offer. Please let me know if this is something you would be interested in, or if you have any questions. Please use this Calendly to schedule a meeting if you're interested! I look forward to hearing from you!

Best,
Evelyn

Potential Partner	Advantages	Disadvantages
Dalmata: Trendy jewelry store	▸ Popular jewelry store with large social media following of 138K ▸ Worn by well-known celebrities, which would spark interest in Monta Vista students ▸ Willingness to share experiences and knowledge	▸ Unreliable communication, difficult to collaborate even after the partnership is established ▸ Small team, meaning little capacity for the project ▸ Lack of solid time commitment

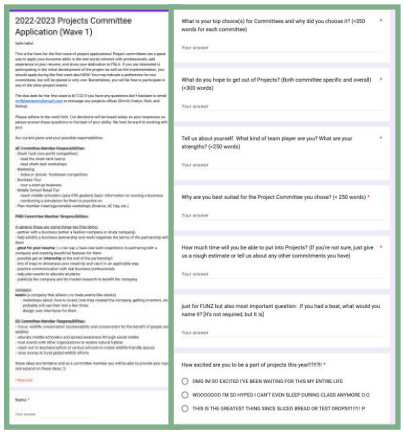
Potential Partner	Advantages	Disadvantages
Study Bunny: Productivity and study timer app	▸ Centered around productivity, more relevant to students for improving study habits ▸ Open to giving MVFBLA opportunities to help with its marketing strategies	▸ Study service more geared towards younger demographic ▸ Not looking to further develop their app, meaning little opportunities for MVFBLA to make a significant impact
Kalshi: Federally-regulated event exchange	▸ Innovative service is the first in the world, very interesting to Monta Vista students ▸ In the financial technology sector, highly relevant to students interested in both STEM and business ▸ Professionals are extremely qualified and enthusiastic to host a variety of workshops for chapter members on startups, finance, and technology ▸ Very communicative and open to opportunities for members to contribute to Kalshi's product and marketing	▸ Service is only for those 18+, so the target market is not high school students ▸ Federally regulated, meaning there are limitations for what MVFBLA can contribute

After evaluating feedback from the three companies, Kalshi emerged as the top choice due to three key reasons. Firstly, Prabhath Kotha, one of Kalshi's engineers, showed great enthusiasm for the partnership and saw a lot of potential in what Monta Vista FBLA could offer. Additionally, members would have the opportunity to learn directly from the Kalshi team, as they were very easy to communicate with and willing to share their experiences and expertise through mentorships, guest speakers, and workshops. Lastly, Kalshi was particularly appealing to students, as many at Monta Vista are interested in technology and startups as a career. Monta Vista FBLA recognized Kalshi's eagerness to work with the chapter, the unique opportunities they provided, and the company's attractiveness to Monta Vista students.

Development of Project Futures

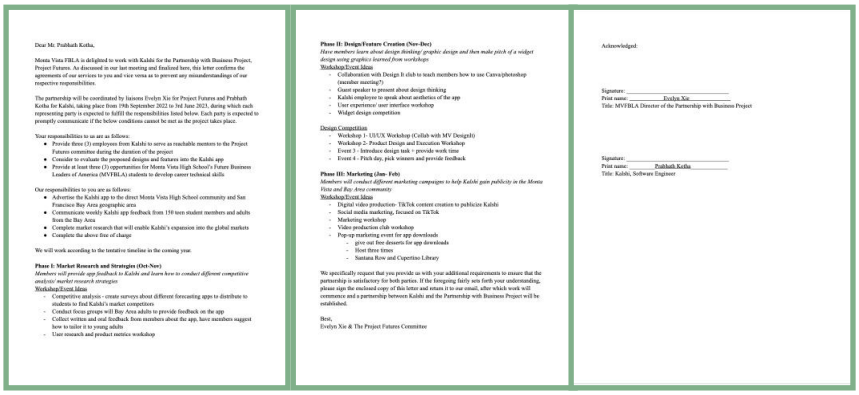
Committee Applications

In order to allow passionate students to get more involved in the planning and behind-the-scenes of Project Futures, members were given the opportunity to apply for a Projects Committee. The committee applications were divided into two waves of applications, the first wave opening over the summer for prior FBLA members to aid in the early stages of development and the second opening primarily to freshmen members, to increase underclassmen membership and involvement. The Project Futures committee consisted of seven members, built to include diversity of gender, age, and experience to ensure there would be a variety of ideas and perspectives introduced and implemented into the project.



Letter of Engagement

The Project Committee and Kalshi engineer, Prabhath Kotha, drafted a letter of engagement to officially establish the partnership in September 2022. The letter outlined the basis of the partnership, the key responsibilities of each partner, and the tentative timeline for the duration of the partnership from the 2022-23 school year. The letter was signed by the Evelyn Xie and Prabhath Kotha.



Dear Mr. Prabhath Kotha,

Monta Vista FBLA is delighted to work with Kalshi for the Partnership with Business Project, Project Futures. As discussed in our last meeting and finalized here, this letter confirms the agreements of our services to you and vice versa as to prevent any misunderstandings of our respective responsibilities.

The partnership will be coordinated by liaisons Evelyn Xie for Project Futures and Prabhath Kotha for Kalshi, taking place from 19th September 2022 to 3rd June 2023, during which each representing party is expected to fulfill the responsibilities listed below. Each party is expected to promptly communicate if the below conditions cannot be met as the project takes place.

Your responsibilities to us are as follows:
- Provide three (3) employees from Kalshi to serve as reachable mentors to the Project Futures committee during the duration of the project
- Consider to evaluate the proposed designs and features into the Kalshi app
- Provide at least three (3) opportunities for Monta Vista High School's Future Business Leaders of America (MVFBLA) students to develop career technical skills

Our responsibilities to you are as follows:
- Advertise the Kalshi app to the direct Monta Vista High School community and San Francisco Bay Area geographic area
- Communicate weekly Kalshi app feedback from 150 teen student members and adults from the Bay Area
- Complete market research that will enable Kalshi's expansion into the global markets
- Complete the above free of charge

We will work according to the tentative timeline in the coming year.

Phase I: Market Research and Strategies (Oct-Nov)
Members will provide app feedback to Kalshi and learn how to conduct different competitive analysis/ research strategies
Workshop/Event Ideas
- Competitive analysis - create surveys about different forecasting apps to distribute to students to find Kalshi's market competitors
- Conduct focus groups will Bay Area adults to provide feedback on the app
- Collect written and oral feedback from members about the app, have members suggest how to tailor it to young adults
- User research and product metrics workshop

Phase II: Design/Feature Creation (Nov-Dec)
Have members learn about design thinking/ graphic design and then make pitch of a widget design using graphics learned from workshops
Workshop/Event Ideas
- Collaboration with Design It club to teach members how to use Canva/photoshop (member meeting?)
- Guest speaker to present about design thinking
- Kalshi employee to speak about aesthetics of the app
- User experience/ user interface workshop
- Widget design competition

Design Competition
- Workshop 1: UI/UX Workshop (Collab with MV Design It)
- Workshop 2- Product Design and Execution Workshop
- Event 3 - Introduce design task + provide work time
- Event 4 - Pitch day, pick winners and provide feedback

Phase III: Marketing (Jan- Feb)
Members will conduct different marketing campaigns to help Kalshi gain publicity in the Monta Vista and Bay Area community
Workshop/Event Ideas
- Digital video production- TikTok content creation to publicize Kalshi
- Social media marketing, focused on TikTok
- Marketing workshop
- Video production club workshop
- Pop-up marketing event for app downloads
  - give out free desserts for app downloads
    - Host three times
    - Santana Row and Cupertino Library

We specifically request that you provide us with your additional requirements to ensure that the partnership is satisfactory for both parties. If the foregoing fairly sets forth your understanding, please sign the enclosed copy of this letter and return it to our email, after which work will commence and a partnership between Kalshi and the Partnership with Business Project will be established.

Best,
Evelyn Xie & The Project Futures Committee

Acknowledged:

Signature: _____
Print name: Evelyn Xie
Title: MVFBLA Director of the Partnership with Business Project

Signature: _____
Print name: Prabhath Kotha
Title: Kalshi, Software Engineer

Project Futures Introductory Meeting

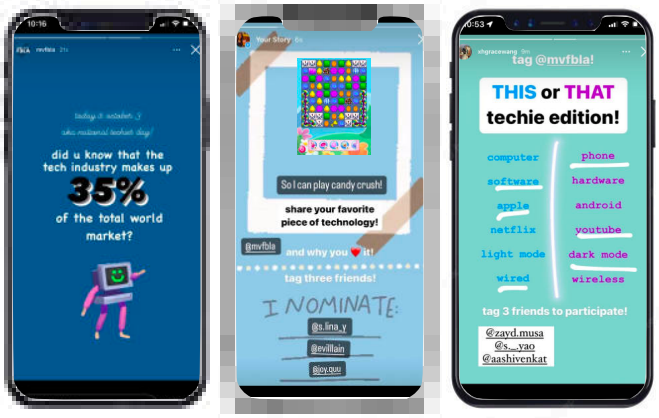


Activity winner Mahathi Ammu

The PWB Committee introduced the Partnership with Business Project to the Monta Vista FBLA chapter at the member meeting on Thursday, October 6th, which had over 60 attendees. The meeting began with an introduction of Kalshi and an overview of events that Project Futures would be holding in the future. For the remainder of the meeting, students competed to win a $15 Starbucks gift card in an online activity called Build Your Stax, a game where students learn about different investment options and invest virtual money. This event not only gave students a chance to learn about Kalshi, but also introduced them the complex world of investing. Project Futures utilized the participation this event received to ensure the success of future events.

2023 Techies Day

To introduce Project Future's concentration in fintech, Project Futures celebrated National Techies Day on October 3rd, a day to spotlight to contributions of technology professionals and encourage students to pursue a career in technology by posting three social media graphics. The graphics were posted on Monta Vista FBLA's Instagram story, and included statistics to emphasize the impact of technology, as well as interactive challenge that allowed students to post their own experiences with technology. This event increased excitement around careers in technology and gained a combined 2000+ views and 200+ direct interactions.



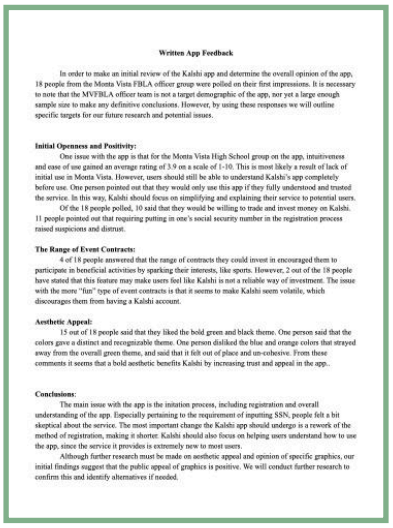
Implementation of Project Futures

After thorough planning, the project committee developed three phases for implementation. Phase I consisted of market research/strategies, Phase II with design thinking and feature development, followed by marketing in phase III.

Phase I: App Feedback and Market Research

Written App Feedback

On October 4th, 18 people from the MVFBLA officer team provided detailed app feedback. The members started the event by downloading and testing the Kalshi app, becoming familiar with the interface and offering their feedback. Many students were extremely impressed with the UI and intrigued by the range of events that could be traded on, but almost offered suggestions regarding the difficulty of understanding of how Kalshi operates and the length of the registration process. Members' comments were compiled onto a formal report, informing Kalshi on how it could improve to target young adults.



Written App Feedback

In order to make an initial review of the Kalshi app and determine the overall opinion of the app, 18 people from the Monta Vista FBLA officer group were polled on their first impressions. It is necessary to note that the MVFBLA officer team is not a target demographic of the app, nor yet a large enough sample size to make any definitive conclusions. However, by using these responses we will outline specific targets for our future research and potential issues.

Initial Openness and Positivity:

One issue with the app is that for the Monta Vista High School group on the app, intuitiveness and ease of use gained an average rating of 3.9 on a scale of 1-10. This is most likely a result of lack of initial use in Monta Vista. However, users should still be able to understand Kalshi's app completely before use. One person pointed out that they would only use this app if they fully understood and trusted the service. In this way, Kalshi should focus on simplifying and explaining their service to potential users.

Of the 18 people polled, 10 said that they would be willing to trade and invest money on Kalshi. 11 people pointed out that requiring putting in one's social security number in the registration process raised suspicions and distrust.

The Range of Event Contracts:

4 of 18 people answered that the range of contracts they could invest in encouraged them to participate in beneficial activities by sparking their interests, like sports. However, 2 out of the 18 people have stated that this feature may make users feel like Kalshi is not a reliable way of investment. The issue with the more "fun" type of event contracts is that it seems to make Kalshi seem volatile, which discourages them from having a Kalshi account.

Aesthetic Appeal:

15 out of 18 people said that they liked the bold green and black theme. One person said that the colors gave a distinct and recognizable theme. One person disliked the blue and orange colors that strayed away from the overall green theme, and said that it felt out of place and un-cohesive. From these comments it seems that a bold aesthetic benefits Kalshi by increasing trust and appeal in the app..

Conclusions:

The main issue with the app is the initation process, including registration and overall understanding of the app. Especially pertaining to the requirement of inputting SSN, people felt a bit skeptical about the service. The most important change the Kalshi app should undergo is a rework of the method of registration, making it shorter. Kalshi should also focus on helping users understand how to use the app, since the service it provides is extremely new to most users.

Although further research must be made on aesthetic appeal and opinion of specific graphics, our initial findings suggest that the public appeal of graphics is positive. We will conduct further research to confirm this and identify alternatives if needed.

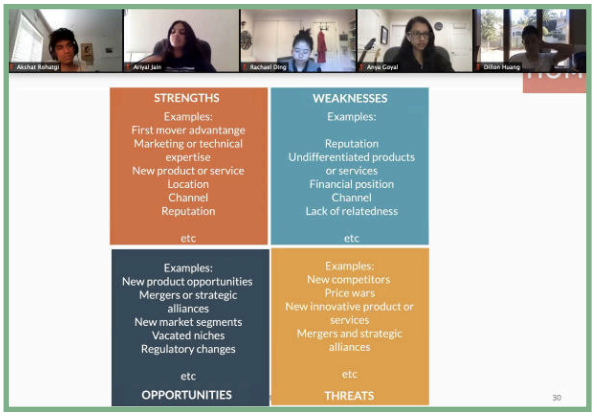
Focus Groups

To gain insight on the opinions of Bay Area adults, committee members hosted five focus groups, each with ten adults, most of which had experience working in technology or finance. Because these adults had more knowledge about the technology and finance industries, they expressed much less openness to Kalshi's app, allowing Monta Vista FBLA to unveil doubts that people had about Kalshi's service. Most felt that requiring a social security number in the registration process made them hesitant, and believed that trading on Kalshi was too volatile. Committee members wrote down concerns brought up in these focus groups, then brainstormed ideas on how to combat them. Members then met with Kalshi professionals to present their findings and ideas, which included emphasizing the forecasting feature of Kalshi and the necessity of SSN's to keep their accounts secure. (The majority of those that participated in focus groups preferred to stay anonymous.)

"As someone who has retired from working in Wall Street, I'm glad my input will be of help. I'll definitely look more into Kalshi and follow its development to see how it changes." - Elizabeth Lee, focus group participant

Competitor Analysis

On October 15th, Project Futures hosted a virtual competitor analysis workshop with Kalshi, gaining over 50 attendees. Kalshi engineer Prabhath Kotha began the workshop with a detailed presentation on how to conduct a thorough 4-step competitive analysis that taught members how to identify the competition, analyze the competitive landscape, assess their positioning, and create a perceptual map. Members were then split into separate groups, where each group used the skills they learned from the presentation to create a SWOT analysis for a competitor of Kalshi, including AlpacaJapan, Markets, and Consensus Point. Finally, the workshop concluded with groups presenting their findings to everyone at the meeting, providing feedback on how Kalshi could differentiate from its competitors.



User Research and Product Metrics Workshop

The final workshop in Phase I invited over 60 students to learn about data-collection tactics necessary to make informed decisions and create successful products that meet the needs of a company's target audience. During this workshop, members learned about various research methods, such as surveys, focus groups, and user interviews, and how to use these techniques to gather valuable insights about their target audience. They also learned how to analyze and interpret product metrics, including engagement rates, retention rates, and user feedback, to identify areas for improvement and optimize product performance. Altogether, members gained a practical understanding of how user research and product metrics work together to drive product development and improve the overall user experience.

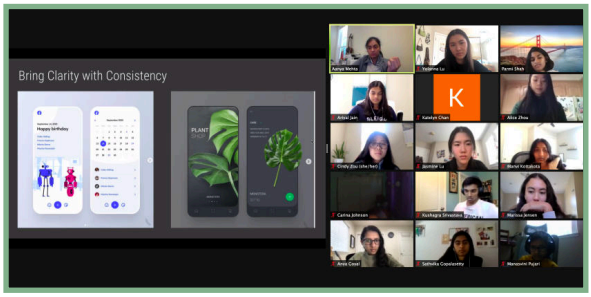
Phase 2: Design and Feature Development

Widget Feature Design Competition

From late November to early December, the committee held a series of events to provide students with an opportunity to design a potential widget design for Kalshi. 40+ high school participants were first taught the basics of design thinking and feature development. After 2 workshops, participants were divided into groups of up to 3 to create and pitch a widget design in a design competition. Feedback was provided to participants by Kalshi engineer Lior Hirschfield, who judged the competition, and the winning design was given the chance to be implemented by Kalshi.



UI/UX Workshop



To equip members with the skills to design an aesthetic and functional widget, Project Futures hosted a workshop with Monta Vista's graphic design club, DesignIt, to teach participants the basics of designing a successful user experience. Members were first asked to consider user perspective through 4-part empathy maps when designing a feature or another type of web product, then were taught basic UX principles about color palettes, readability, and branding to ensure that their designs were cohesive and attractive.

Product Design and Execution Workshop

Project Future's hosted its second workshop to teach members about key skills in product design and improve their ability to create successful products, like the widget they would be designing, to meet user needs. Members were first taught the basics of design thinking, including empathizing with users, defining the problem, ideating solutions, and how to apply these principles to product design. They were then introduced to how businesses bring products to life, including how features are prioritized to meet business goals and how roadmaps are created for feature development.

Introduction of Design Task and Work Sessions

The task of designing a widget was given to students on November 26th. Members were challenged to create a widget for iPhone home screens that displayed an already existing Kalshi feature, or one they came up with themselves, in order to increase Kalshi users' engagement with the Kalshi app when using their phones. Students were given two weeks to prepare for pitch day, and weekly work sessions were hosted in partnership with Monta Vista's Computer Science Club to increase resources and support available to participants.

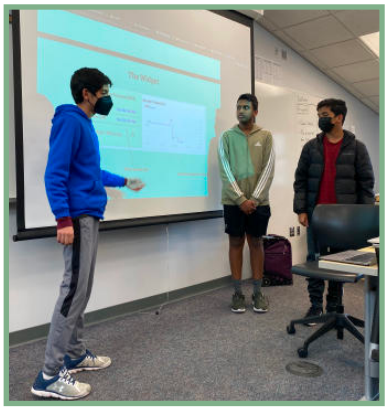
Pitch Day

8 teams presented their proposed widget designs for Kalshi to Lior Hirschfield and David Xu, both of which had extensive experience in the software and product engineering fields, making them well-suited to evaluating the designs presented to them. Ideas ranged from displaying market predictions to recommending popular trades, and participants were judged based on their design thinking, the overall aesthetics of the design, and their pitch. After some deliberation, the judges ultimately selected a widget featuring a user's last traded event as the winning feature due to its simplicity and practicality.





Winning design by Selina Yang and Rajvansh Gupta





"I learned a lot from the workshops and I liked how I could apply the things I learned in the design competition. It was overall a great experience and I'll definitely be able to use the design knowledge I gained through this experience in my FBLA event." - Grace Wang, participant

Shark Tank Competition

Inspired by Kalshi founders Tarek Mansour and Luana Lara and the success and impacts they have made through their startup, chapter members were excited to learn about entrepreneurship and the process of creating their own startup. With Kalshi's support, Project Futures assisted in hosting the Shark Tank Competition to teach 70 students how to write and present their own business plan.

In accordance with Project Future's goal of building members' business skills, the project committee held a series of two two-hour long workshops about elevator pitches and marketing with guest speaker business professional Kristin Polidoro. The final Pitch Day event took place on January 14th, 2023 with pitch ideas consisting of unique non profit organizations that ranged from a fitness app to pottery-centered nonprofits. After each presentation, a panel of judges, containing employees from Kalshi, offered their personal feedback, and the event concluded with the judges agreeing on a winner, which won a $500 cash prize as well as future assistance to kickstart their venture. Through this hands-on experience, participants emerged as better leaders and entrepreneurs with a deeper understanding of design thinking, strategy and finance, and persuasive pitching and presentation skills.



Winning team, Palette Pals

Phase 3: Marketing

Social Media Marketing

With the increasing use of social media by consumers, Project Futures utilized social media platforms such as Instagram, Twitter, and TikTok in order to increase Kalshi's exposure to its target market. Members were first introduced to crucial concepts required to create successful social media content, including general marketing strategies and content creation strategies. Members were then challenged to conceptualize, create, and present a video and script for Kalshi's TikTok, which features relevant and intriguing finance and technology news topics. The videos students created ranged from explaining the Theranos case to music NFTs, providing a breadth of ideas for future official Kalshi posts.

Marketing Workshop

Members were introduced to basic marketing concepts, including price, product, place, and promotion, by Kalshi engineer Prabhath Kotha. Each concept was then explained in more depth to apply to startups like Kalshi, giving members a better understanding of how marketing campaigns specifically tailored aspects of the marketing mix to to align with a company's brand, and target market, among other factors.

"I really enjoyed the marketing workshop, especially since it explained how startups specifically do marketing. I really want to work at a startup in the future, so these skills will really help me with my career development." - Smriti Rangarajan, attendee

Video Production Club

In order to make Kalshi's products more well known, Project Futures collaborated with the Video Making Club (VMC) at Monta Vista, to boost Kalshi's TikTok account. After outlining the requirements and specifications for the video in a brief meeting with Prabhath, VMC proceeded to explain how to create a storyboard, write an engaging script, create eye-catching visuals, and use basic editing skills to create a cohesive video.

TikTok Content Creation

The creation process took around two weeks from February 7th to March 5th, and allowed participants to improve their digital media and collaboration skills, while expanding Kalshi's marketing campaign. More than 40 students participated, forming groups of five, to brainstorm, conceptualize, film, and produce a TikTok that explained an interesting technology or finance-related figure, event, or phenomenon that fit the rest of Kalshi's TikTok content. The finished content was presented to all participants and Kalshi professionals during a dedicated "showing" meeting.



mind-map created during brainstorming process

Popup Marketing

In an effort to strengthen the relationship between Kalshi and the community in Silicon Valley, Project Futures organized three pop-up events during March. These events served as an opportunity to connect with the local community and raise awareness of the Kalshi app. To incentivize participation, the pop-up events offered free desserts to individuals who downloaded the Kalshi app and registered for an account. The pop-up was hosted in two locations: Santana Row, a popular mall, and the Cupertino Library, both of which provided heavy foot traffic and high levels of engagement.

Project Futures was able to help Kalshi rapidly gain over **150 app downloads in the span of two weeks.** The pop-up provided Kalshi with extremely low customer acquisition costs, at about $1.67 per customer, compared to traditional marketing campaigns. Overall, by using this unique in-person approach, Project Futures was able to effectively promote the Kalshi app and build stronger connections with the local community in Silicon Valley.

"Wow! 150 downloads is amazing—I think I'm speaking for the rest of Kalshi when I say that I'm super impressed and grateful to [Project Futures] for guiding the success of the Kalshi app launch."
- Lior Hirschfield, Kalshi professional











Evidence of Publicity

Formal Recognition

Through Project Futures, members gained knowledge on business operations, developed career-oriented skills, and assisted in the success of a partnership with a startup, while simultaneously increasing mental health awareness within the community. Because of this, Project Futures received recognition in multiple ways by partners, publications, and government officials for its impact on the members of Monta Vista FBLA and Kalshi. The Cupertino Mayor Darcy Paul commended Project Futures' efforts in providing business education and opportunities and the tremendous impact created with a City of Cupertino Certificate of Appreciation. The Cupertino Chamber of Commerce also recognized Project Futures' contributions with a letter of recognition.


CUPERTINO

Certificate of Appreciation

Presented to the

Monta Vista Partnership with Business Project

March 2023

In Appreciation for the Partnership with Business project, for providing educational opportunities to those in our community through a student partnership with a financial technology organization.

The City of Cupertino thanks you for utilizing this project to provide students an inside look into business, marketing, app development, and more.

Darcy Paul
Mayor


CUPERTINO

March 2, 2023

Evelyn Xie
"Monta Vista FBLA Partnership with Business Project" Monta Vista Future Business Leaders of America 21840 McClellan Rd
Cupertino, CA 95014

Dear Evelyn,

This letter is to provide formal recognition of your work on educating students about entrepreneurship.

We were impressed to hear about all the different activities that you have held to further the career development of Monta Vista FBLA members, such as the series of workshops educating members on the essence of startups and product design. These skills are especially important when starting a business, whether in Cupertino, in the local area, or even online. The Shark Tank event, where members had the opportunity to present their business plans to Facebook professionals, entrepreneurs, and angel investors, is a commendable effort on your part to give Monta Vista FBLA members important hands-on experience marketing their business dreams and ideas.

We congratulate you on the success of the Shark Tank event and your other entrepreneurial programs, and thank you again for sharing the efforts of your team with us.

Sincerely,

Victoria Low
Program Coordinator
Cupertino Chamber of Commerce

Publicity by Kalshi

Kalshi issued an official letter of recognition acknowledging the positive impacts created on Kalshi through the partnership with Project Futures, particularly through the app downloads and widget design competition. The letter was signed by Kalshi engineer Lior Hirschfield, who expressed his gratitude for the collaboration and praised the contributions made by Project Futures in enhancing Kalshi's offerings. He also noted that the partnership had been instrumental in expanding the company's reach and attracting new users to its platform. Kalshi's official Instagram also featured a post for the pop-up, indicating a partnership with MVFBLA.


Kalshi

Dear Evelyn,

I would like to formally recognize the fantastic work you and MVFBLA have done to bring attention to Kalshi and explore improvements to our product.

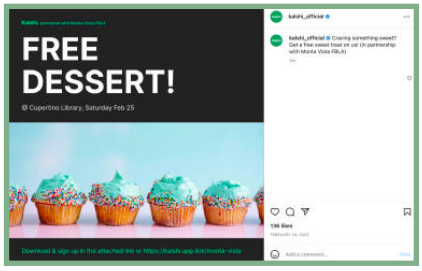
Over the past few months, MVFBLA has conducted several Kalshi pop-ups which have led to over 100 downloads of Kalshi's new mobile app - the feedback from this cohort has helped us immensely in iterating on our product. The widget design competition you led was also very useful, and produced several fruitful ideas which will certainly influence our feature design going forward.

Thank you so much for your help; MVFBLA has been wonderful to work with and has led to measurable improvements in our company.

Sincerely,

Lior Hirschfeld

Lior Hirschfeld
Software & Growth Engineer, Kalshi



Publicity by Project Futures

Throughout the partnership, Project Futures utilized flyers and blurbs through the MVFBLA email, website, and social media platforms to update members on upcoming competitive events, workshops, and opportunities. Chapter members also joined the effort by publicizing project events and reposting Instagram and Facebook posts on their personal accounts to reach a larger audience and invite others to participate. MVFBLA Instagram posts were even featured in Monta Vista High School's official Instagram account, broadcasting Project Futures' events to a wider audience. In addition to social media, the MVFBLA website was regularly updated with the Project Futures' events throughout the school year.





Degree of Impact

Impact on Kalshi

Before	After
Phase 1: ‣ Kalshi received minimal feedback from reviews on the App Store (73 reviews) which included little criticism or suggestions for improvement ‣ Kalshi received little user feedback on its app from the Bay Area	‣ Kalshi was given feedback from 68 Bay Area participants, including 18 teens/young adults from the MVFBLA officer team and 50 adults, most of which were knowledgeable in the technology and finance fields ‣ Suggestions for improvement were provided to Kalshi, including brainstormed ideas to address user feedback
Phase 2: ‣ Kalshi had the idea of creating widgets for its mobile app, but did have the capacity to pursue designing them	‣ More than 10 complete and professional possible widget designs were developed by members ‣ Each widget design was carefully thought out and pitched to Kalshi for their use ‣ Influenced Kalshi feature design for future developments
Phase 3: ‣ Kalshi had a few viral TikToks, but struggled to find consistent success on social media and was running out of ideas ‣ The Kalshi app had little downloads and users, compared to the original desktop site	‣ Kalshi was given more viral TikTok ideas created by teens, who comprise the majority of TikTok users ‣ TikTok ideas contributed to increased engagement throughout Kalshi social media platforms ‣ Project Futures helped Kalshi gain more than 100 app downloads through a pop-up marketing stand, leading to rapid growth and a boost on the App Store

Impact on Monta Vista FBLA members

In order to gauge Project Futures' chapter and community effects in a quantifiable manner, surveys were given to those who participated in Project Futures events. A survey was given prior to Project Futures' events for members to evaluate their skills, rating their confidence in their knowledge of certain concepts or of certain skills from 1-worst to 5-best scale. After Project Futures' events, a second survey was issued, allowing members to reevaluate their skills. Over 70 people filled out the survey, and the large majority of survey respondents ranked their experience a 10 on a 1-worst to 10-best scale.

9.8
average overall **satisfaction** rating

**Out of the 73 Monta Vista High School FBLA members surveyed*

Degree of Impact

Skill and Corresponding Goal	Definition of Mastery (5) and Activities to Reach Mastery	% of 5's at Start of Project	% of 5's at End of Project
Graphic design (goal 2)	"I can consistently create visually compelling designs using a range of design techniques, principles, and tools." ‣ UI/UX Workshop ‣ Product Design and Execution Workshop ‣ Widget Design Competition	11.1%	87.9%
Design thinking (goal 2)	"I can solve problems using a human-centered design process of empathizing, defining, ideating, prototyping, and iterating." ‣ UI/UX Workshop ‣ Product Design and Execution Workshop ‣ Widget Design Competition	7.5%	87.1%
Presentation and communication (goal 3)	"I can confidently convey my ideas through clear, concise, and engaging presentations." ‣ Widget Design Pitch Day ‣ Shark Tank Competition ‣ TikTok Content Creation	16.2%	90.5%
Collaboration and interpersonal skills (goal 3)	"I can work effectively with others towards a common goal, utilizing strong leadership and communication skills." ‣ Competitor Analysis Workshop ‣ Widget Design Competition ‣ TikTok Content Creation	18.6%	94.2%
Data collection and analytics (goal 4)	"I can collect, process, and analyze data to draw meaningful insights to help inform business decisions." ‣ Competitor Analysis ‣ User Research and Product Metrics Workshop ‣ Product Design and Execution Workshop	9.3%	84.2%
Marketing (goal 5)	"I can strategically promote a product to target audiences, utilizing a mix of creative, analytical, and technical skills." ‣ Marketing Workshop ‣ TikTok Content Creation	13.1%	93.7%

Evaluation of Project Futures

Recommendations for Change

Although Project Futures was successful in surpassing each of the chapter's goals, the project director Evelyn Xie determined that the following changes would create an even larger impact if the project were to be repeated for future years:

1) Broaden the range of professional guest speakers and mentors.

While many of the business and career-oriented events were instructed by Kalshi professionals, attendees expressed a desire for different guest speakers and workshop mentors who could've brought more diverse perspectives. Even though it allowed for greater focus surrounding the Kalshi app and the company, it would have been valuable for members to gain insight into different business perspectives, market strategies, and more.

2) Notify members in advance of meeting agendas and recap for absentees.

Project Futures maintained high engagement throughout the year, but due to school field trips, sickness, and forgetfulness, many members missed at least one meeting. To combat this, Project Futures began sending reminder emails prior to each meeting and summary emails after each meeting to maximize the number of members present.

3) Request more feedback from members.

Project Futures could have sought out more feedback from members in order to understand what events they enjoyed, and what events they didn't. This information could have been used to host more engaging events for members by tailoring events and workshops to members' interests.

4) Utilize more face-to-face communication between liaisons and Monta Vista FBLA.

The majority of communication between the Project Futures and Kalshi was via email due to the time difference between Kalshi's office in New York and Monta Vista's location in California. In the future, Project Futures hopes to find more times that work for both sides of the partnership to meet via Zoom, to foster a connected environment.

Hours Spent

Event	Hours Spent
Project Meetings	871
Officer Meetings	346
Liaison Meetings	232
Contact Potential Partners	189
Project Planning and Development	745
Speaking and Presentation Events	298
App Feedback	315
Workshops	122
Committee/Outside Events	502
Marketing	575
Total Hours Spent	**4195**

Conclusion

The partnership proved to be mutually beneficial for members and Kalshi, while also benefitting Monta Vista FBLA itself. Overall, Project Futures was a success as members were able to gain special career skills, and Kalshi was able to improve its mobile app and expand to both global and local Bay Area markets. Project Futures would like to thank Kalshi, the Partnership With Business committee, and the members of Monta Vista FBLA for making the project possible. With these parties' hard work and dedication, this project was able to extend its reach and maximize its impact for years to come. Project Futures looks forward to continuing its work in the future.

